



In conversation with Yotta CEO Sunil Gupta on India's datacentre industry journey

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For those of you who've never stepped foot inside a datacentre, imagine it to be the digital footprint of a huge township – a tiny city within a megacity like Mumbai. A heavily guarded fortress of data unlike anything you will have ever seen, processing an insane amount of data every single second, according to Sunil Gupta.

"If I have to give you some perspective, we have an average bandwidth of close to 1Tbps here," Sunil Gupta told us, "And my monthly electricity bill easily crosses into eight figures, roughly making up 60-percent of this datacentre's operational cost." Makes your average monthly internet and electricity bill feel infinitesimally small, doesn't it? But that's exactly what you'll experience when you learn more about datacentres.

Popularly known as the 'Datacentre Man of India,' we met Sunil Gupta, CEO of Yotta, at the Yotta Datacentre

Park on the outskirts of Mumbai. Edited interview excerpts follow:

Q How would you explain a datacentre to someone who has absolutely no idea about it?



India's Datacentre Man – Sunil Gupta

Sunil Gupta: To put it very simply, knowingly or unknowingly we all are users of datacentres. If you connect to the Internet for doing anything, you are directly connecting to a datacentre somewhere in the world. Whether you're using WhatsApp or someone else using Instagram, Snapchat or booking a train ticket or cab on Uber, watching a film on Netflix or netbanking on your bank's app at this very moment. So all this data from our mobile or desktop goes through a 2G, 3G or 4G network provider's node, from there all that information from your digital devices travels through a network of fiber-optic cables to get processed and stored in a place called the datacentre. Every digital transaction which we are doing in our personal or professional life today, through our mobile, desktop, laptop, or smart TV's have only three components: a device, the network in between and the backend – that backend is nothing but the data centre.